that the Modi government, by redefining the parameters of this bilateral relationship, has delinked strategic autonomy from India's traditional policy of non-alignment. He notes that three factors appear to have had a significant influence on India altering its policy towards the United States: at the structural level, changes in India's security environment brought about by a more powerful and aggressive China; at the domestic level, in the form of the strong position Prime Minister Modi enjoys within his own party and in the Indian Parliament; and, lastly, through the political authority and world outlook of the Prime Minister himself. The chapter then discusses where on the spectrum of alignments – weak, moderate, or strong – India's relationship with the United States is now best characterised.

P.S. Raghavan examines how the emergence of a new geopolitical landscape has set in motion developments challenging India's traditional friendship with Russia. Despite Russia's growing dependence on China and the progressive deterioration in Russia's relationship with the United States challenging New Delhi's traditional ties with Moscow, Raghavan argues that India's deepening strategic relationship with the United States cannot be at the cost of relations with Russia, as both relationships are important for India's effort to narrow its asymmetry of economic and military power vis-à-vis China. Chapter 12, by **Rohan Mukherjee**, examines the drivers behind the remarkable upswing in India's relationship with Japan. He argues that India's Japan policy is not part of an Indian external balancing policy towards China, as there is little chance of the two countries effectively balancing against China. Rather, he notes that the main driving forces behind the India–Japan rapprochement are more subtle and long-term, coordinating policies and, above all, building an economic basis. It is only when India and Japan can sustain an *economic* logic of cooperation that they will be able to